

## ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

### PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in an online newspaper:

#### Ice Bucket Challenge

Chances are if you've spent any time on social media in the past couple of years, you will have seen people throw a bucket of ice water over their heads to raise awareness for people who suffer from amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (ALS). If you have, you've taken part in a viral online campaign for a good cause.

Here's how the Ice Bucket Challenge works: someone who wants to participate (or has been "challenged" via social media by a friend) films themselves dumping a bucket of ice water on their head. This person then challenges a friend to do the same in the name of ALS, within 24 hours, and/or donate money to the cause.

"People want to do something for the world. They want to contribute, but they want it to be easy," said Christine Outram, a charity representative. "It's great because you have something that makes you feel good but isn't too hard to accomplish."

The viral challenge actually started when Pete Frates, a 29-year-old American resident diagnosed with ALS, had a bucket of water thrown over his head and he started posting pictures of the challenge on social media with his father's help. The pictures quickly went viral and spread across the internet.

"It is certainly amazing to see how far and wide the campaign continues to spread, increasing both awareness and funds," said Christine. "Since the start of the challenge, there have been more than 307,600 posts on Twitter and public Facebook pages."

Your school is raising money for Hong Kong charities. Your group has been asked to consider if online activities such as the Ice Bucket Challenge would be suitable. You may want to talk about:

- why the Ice Bucket Challenge was so successful
- other online activities you could hold to raise money for charity
- whether your suggestions would be popular
- anything else you think is important

### PART B Individual Response

1. Have you ever raised money for charity?
2. Would you take part in an activity such as the Ice Bucket Challenge?
3. Who would you invite to do the Ice Bucket Challenge?
4. Apart from raising money, how else could you help charities?
5. Why should students help charities?
6. Should private companies support charities?
7. Is social media the best way for young people to get involved in charity?
8. Which is more important for charities: raising awareness or raising money?